

Ernest SONG - Chief Growth & Transformation Officer

📍 Rue Montagne de l'Oratoire 28/76
B-1000 Brussels
✉ contact@ernestsong.com
🌐 ernestsong.com
☎ +32 476 60 05 90

Managing Director and ESCP graduate with a proven track record of driving exponential value, including a 4x acquisition cost valuation at Vinci Airports across 50+ global locations. Expert in business development and digital transformation, I designed and scaled new RPA/BI business models at Tobania and restructured enterprise workflows post-M&A at Holcim via SAP HANA migrations. Melding financial strategy with data analytics (Power BI), I turn complex global operations into high-growth business engines.

Education

ESCP Business School 2010 – 2011 | Paris, FR
(#1 FT 2026)

Specialized Master's degree
Auditing and Consulting

Université Paris Nanterre 2005 – 2010 | Paris, FR

Master's degree
Management Science and Financial Control

Competencies

Business

- MS Office (advanced Excel)

ERP

- SAP HANA

Business Intelligence

- MS Power BI
- QlikSense
- Business Object
- Cognos
- Hyperion

RPA

- Ulpath
- MS PowerAutomate

Agile

- Jira
- Confluence

Audit

- IDEA CAATs

Planning

- Visual Planning

Data & Analytics

- VBA
- SQL
- R

Languages

Native: French, Khmer, Teochew

Proficient: English

Basics: Dutch (A2), Spanish, Mandarin

Interests

Sustainable development, Powerlifting, Mountain biking, Tennis

Interpersonal

Fast-learner, Problem solver, Diplomacy, Driven, Autonomous, Teamplayer

Professional Experience

Engie SEM

January 2026 – Present | Brussels, BE

Strategic Business Analyst & Finance Automation Lead (Freelancer)

- Led the financial controlling pilot phase for the SAP S/4HANA migration across French subsidiaries, successfully acting as the core Business Analyst bridging IT architecture and strategic business operations.
- Designed, built, and deployed a robust, automated budget modeling tool from scratch within a critical 2-week timeline, ensuring operational continuity during a resource gap and replacing an unreliable legacy framework.
- Streamlined and automated financial closing processes for commodity trading activities, deploying advanced PowerQuery ETL workflows to safely ingest batches of 1,500+ bookings per close with zero human intervention.
- Reconciled complex financial data structures between middle-office databases (IVDB) and SAP S/4HANA while restructuring and simplifying the Work Breakdown Structure (WBS) project codes to optimize portfolio monitoring.

Holcim

January 2024 – December 2025 | Nivelles, BE

Senior Operational Excellence & Data Lead (Freelancer)

- Leveraged data insights derived from market analysis to restructure production workflows post-M&A, significantly enhancing efficiency.
- Managed SAP HANA migration, restructuring data and ensuring system integrity.
- Developed rebate models (matrix & automated SAP), aligning with commercial strategy.
- Implemented QlikSense with new data for financial reporting and insights.
- Ensured data reliability and liaised with auditors on rebate matters.

Engie Tractebel

March 2023 – December 2023 | Brussels, BE

Cash Flow & Financial Modeling Specialist (Freelancer)

- Design cashflow reporting and cash exposure per project.
- Assessment of financing needs in local entity, credit analysis of specific counterpart and impairment testing.
- Develop Finance data modelling from SAP for HANA and design Power BI reporting.

Shurgard

February 2022 – February 2023 | Brussels, BE

Investment & Corporate Development Analyst (Freelancer)

- Analyzed and managed real estate projects, including construction, redevelopment, and acquisition of self-storage businesses.
- Maintained project dashboard and initiated corporate development projects to improve department policies and procedures.
- Designed the data model and visualization for the Investment department's Business Intelligence efforts.
- Collaborated in the development of a new pricing model using Artificial Intelligence.

Magnetrap

November 2020 – January 2022 | Mons, BE

Head of Controlling

- Implemented budgeting, forecasting, and financial control systems.
- Created cash flow projections, business plans, and long-term financial goals.
- Monitored company performance and implemented corrective actions as needed.
- Prepared operating results reports and managed financial models for long-term use.

Tobania

February 2020 – October 2020 | Brussels, BE

Director Business Process Automation

- Led development and implementation of citizen developer business model using RPA and self-service BI, including pricing strategy and roadmap.
- Managed business development, including marketing strategy, pre-sales, and sales, and identified new business opportunities.
- Implemented process optimization, standardization, and harmonization to improve efficiency and profitability for customers.
- Provided regular, tailored reports to help customers monitor and control costs and make data-driven business decisions, and established change management structures and strategies to facilitate successful adoption of new processes and technologies.

Soap collect

January 2019 – Present | Phnom Penh, KH

Founder

- Established a non-profit organization focused on providing hygiene products to disadvantaged communities.
- Formed partnerships with luxury hotel chains to source used soap for reconditioning.

Degroof Petercam

January 2018 – December 2018 | Brussels, BE

Performance Management Project Leader

- Finance Transformation Operating Model (FTOM)
- Designed and implemented a client-centric performance management system.
- Optimized finance close process for improved governance, internal control, and data quality.
- Led projects related to regulatory reporting sourcing and followed BPM standards.
- Conducted gap analysis of business requirements and existing procedures to identify areas for improvement.

Vinci Airports

February 2016 – December 2017 | Brussels, BE & Lisbon, PT

Managing Director & Head of Project Financial Modeling / Cursus Grand Talent

- Value creation: valuation at 4 times of acquisition cost.
- Led deployment of airport operations at 50+ locations in various countries.
- Developed long-term financial business model including analysis of macroeconomic impact, capital expenditures, and concession valuation.
- Negotiated extension of concession contract with Portuguese authorities and implemented new financial business model to improve budgeting and forecasting processes.
- Managed accounting and financial reporting in accordance with BE-GAAP standards.

Rexel

September 2014 – January 2016 | Paris, FR

Reporting Consolidation Manager

- Led the implementation of IFRS financial reporting for Asia-Pacific, Latin America, and Canadian subsidiaries.
- Spearheaded the restructuring process and integration of SAP BPC and Cognos reporting systems.
- Performed annual budgeting, monthly forecasting, and analyses of actual vs. budgeted/estimated results.
- Led the strategic planning process for the organization.

Financial Auditor Supervisor

- *Conducted audits of financial statements using various accounting standards, including testing of key processes in accordance with SOX requirements.*
- *Experienced in auditing financial modeling for long-term contracts, particularly in the context of Public-Private Partnerships (PPP).*
- *Certified FP7 Grant Agreements for the EU Research program and led audit teams and supervised financial auditors.*
- *Developed partnerships and identified new markets to support business growth.*

Main sector: Construction (Vinci, Eiffage, Colas), Real estate (Nexity), Water distribution (Veolia), International parcels distribution (Geopost from La Poste group), Security (Brink's), Healthcare (DomusVie).

ICM - Brain & Spine Institute

November 2009 – August 2010 | Paris, FR

Deputy CFO Trainee

- *Implemented the budget system and prepared business plans for the scientific teams.*
- *Established the internal control system for purchasing and donation processes and managed bank reconciliation.*
- *Prepared the institutional audit necessary for the certification by the "Comité de la Charte".*